

GOV 360E

Fall 2025



Course Title

IPE

Course Information

Instructional Mode: Face-to-face

Meeting Times: Mon/Wed 02:00 PM - 03:30 PM

Meeting Location: RLP 1.104

Unique Number: 39605

Instructor



Professor: Dr. Rachel Wellhausen

Email: rwellhausen@utexas.edu

Office Hours and Location

Professor: Dr. Rachel Wellhausen (Canvas message or rwellhausen@utexas.edu)

- Informal office hours: Hang out after class, in the vicinity of our classroom (approx 30 min)

- Office hours by appointment Wed, 9-12 AM, in person at BAT 4.138 or on Zoom: [sign up here](#) Alternative times available on request; please just reach out.
- Learn more about Professor Wellhausen and her research [at her website](#).

Why should you hang out after class or make an appointment to come to the professor's office hours? Please take advantage of the opportunity to connect outside of class. Potential topics to discuss include class material, current events, IPE in general, the professor's research, research opportunities for you, your career and/or future education plans, etc.! You are also welcome to come by in a group, so we can all bounce ideas off of each other. The professor may ask you to stop by in lieu of a written response to a written question; conversations are nearly always better.

Disclaimers: Course administration questions? Contact the TA first. Expect emails to be responded to during normal business hours.

Teaching Assistants

TA: Yunyi Huang (Canvas message or yunyi.huang@utexas.edu)

- Office hours: TBD, in person at BAT 1.118 or or on Zoom (<https://utexas.zoom.us/j/2024408012>).
- An appointment is not necessary. You are welcome to walk-in or hop on Zoom at any point during office hours windows.
- Learn more about Yunyi and her research [at her website](#).

Why should you come to the TA's office hours? The TA is your best sounding board for specific questions about your grade, getting feedback on quizzes and tests, and brainstorming the best ways to organize your time and effort so that you achieve the grade you would like in the course. The TA is also an expert in international relations and IPE, in the midst of their own research, and in a PhD program – so they have a unique and important perspective that can be very useful to you. Taking a few minutes to have an in-person conversation with the TA is nearly always better than engaging in a typed back-and-forth. The TA may ask you to stop by in lieu of a written response to a written question.

Disclaimers: Course administration questions? Contact the TA first. Emails will be responded to during normal business hours.

Welcome Message

Welcome to International Political Economy (IPE)!

We're excited for the semester and have lots to learn about the politics of international finance, trade, and multinational corporations. This Fall 2025 class will be especially interesting, given everything that has been happening in and around IPE in these first months of the second Trump administration.

If you'd like to learn more about me and my research, please take a look at my website: <https://www.rwellhausen.com/>. We look forward to getting to know you as we learn together this fall.

Best,

Prof Wellhausen.

Catalog Description

Study of the changing relationship between political and economic power in international relations.

Overview of the Class

Course Description:

The purpose of this course is to provide you with an overview of the study of international political economy. The course's primary focus will be on the role of politics and government decision-making in international economic relations. Thus, while we will cover some topics familiar in the discipline of economics, this is wholly a political science (government) course. That said, students should be willing to engage with some basic relationships in macroeconomics – that government officials deal with on a daily basis. We will also read cutting edge qualitative (prose-based) and quantitative (statistics-based) research. Students should be open to learning to engage with statistical analyses.

We will examine several topics central to IPE, in three modules: the politics around the international monetary system and international finance; the politics around international trade; and the politics of foreign investment by multinational corporations. We will draw on examples from the United States as well as developed and developing countries around the world. We will regularly address current events that are inextricably linked with our course content. We will also examine historical material that provides context and background necessary to understand today's international political economy – why IPE doesn't "have to" operate like it does today, and why.

Teaching Modality Information:

This course is in-person. Slides are posted to Canvas (in advance of class) and classroom recordings are made available through Lectures Online. These materials are intended for review purposes only. The professor reserves the right to include asynchronous learning experiences in the course at her discretion. Attendance is not part of the course grade (see Grading Policy below). That said, 3/4 of extra credit opportunities require in-class attendance.

Pre-Requisites for the Course

Prerequisite: Upper-division standing and six semester hours of lower-division coursework in government. Government 360E and 360N (Topic 11) may not both be counted.

Learning Outcomes

At the conclusion of this course, students will be able to:

- Understand and apply core IPE concepts in the areas of international finance; international trade; and foreign investment by multinational corporations.
- Use IPE concepts to evaluate historical and contemporary government policy choices.
- Recognize and articulate economic policy tradeoffs that generate “winners” and “losers.”
- Organize IPE concepts around national, class, individual, and other units of analysis.

Grading Policy

Grade scale:

Final grades are rounded to the nearest whole number.

- 94 and above A
- 90-93 A-
- 87-89 B+
- 84-86 B

- 80-83 B-
- 77-79 C+
- 74-76 C
- 70-73 C-
- 67-69 D+
- 64-66 D
- 60-63 D-
- 59 and below F

Grade components:

- **Exams:** 75%
 - Module: Politics of International Finance 25%
 - Module: Politics of International Trade 25%
 - Module: Politics of Multinational Corporations 25%
- **Quizzes:** 25%
- **Extra credit:** Completing extra credit can add up to 2% to the final grade

Exam details: The course is arranged around Modules. There will be an exam following each Module that covers the material from that Module. There is no comprehensive final exam. Exams are timed and will consist of a series of short answer questions. The exam format and recommended preparation will be discussed at length in class. You are encouraged to approach the exam from the point of view of gaining points by clearly demonstrating mastery, rather than “losing points.” That’s the principle behind modern pedagogy on student assessment (and, by the way, your personal credit score as well). The professor reserves the right to change the exam content and format at her discretion.

ALL EXAMS ARE IN-PERSON, AND YOU WILL WRITE YOUR EXAMS IN (SELF-PROVIDED) BLUE BOOKS. You must take the exam in person at the designated time, barring extreme extenuating circumstances (as evaluated by the Professor, see details elaborated elsewhere in the syllabus). Do not book travel that conflicts with exams; this is not an extreme extenuating circumstance.

Quiz details: Most class weeks are accompanied by a timed Canvas quiz directly tied to the materials for the week, due prior to the first class of the following week. Quizzes typically consist of five multiple choice questions. The professor reserves the right to change quiz content and format at her discretion. Please bring your questions regarding quizzes to class and/or office hours. Quizzes are intended to be low-stakes opportunities to confirm that you are on track.

Flexibility is built into the design of quizzes as follows: Each student's lowest quiz score will be dropped. A well-prepared student should be able to complete the quiz quickly; that said, you have 15 minutes to complete the quiz from the moment of accessing it. Quizzes are available for students to complete over an extended time period. Quizzes are open-note. We hope you do not discuss questions or answers with other students or AI. This is not in your best interests in terms of learning. No exceptions to quiz policies will be allowed, beyond those laid out in this syllabus.

Extra Credit: Completing extra credit can only add to a student's grade, and not subtract. Completing extra credit will add to the final class grade, with up to a 2% increase in the grade if all extra credit is completed successfully.

The primary source of extra credit will be very low stakes participation-based and/or comprehension-checking "Instapoll" surveys in class sessions. Multiple Instapolls will be conducted in most class sessions. A student must be present in the class session in order to access extra credit made available in the class session. Successfully completing all Instapolls will add a maximum of 1.5% to the student's final grade.

The secondary sources of extra credit are ad hoc out-of-class opportunities available throughout the semester. These will require students to attend and reflect on class-relevant events hosted at and around UT during the course of the semester. Successfully completing all these opportunities will add a maximum of 0.5% to the student's final grade.

Notes on class attendance and participation: Attendance is not part of the course grade. You do not need to notify the professor/TA if absent. It is your responsibility alone to catch up on missed material. The professor/TA will not engage in conversations along the lines of, "What did I miss?" Flexibility with regard to assessment is built into the course design and explained in this syllabus and on Canvas. The student is responsible for knowing and understanding these aspects of the course and how they relate to the student's specific circumstances. Again, 3/4 of extra credit opportunities are only available in class. Because this is purely extra credit, there is no option to "make up" these opportunities because of lack of attendance.

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Additional policies relevant to grading:

Exceptional Circumstances:

In case of emergency that will disrupt your ability to be successful in the course: Students are expected to use Student Emergency Services (SES), <https://deanofstudents.utexas.edu/emergency/>. It is SES's job to work with you and then notify your professors on your behalf. Once notified by SES, the professor will work with you to determine the best course of action and whether additional accommodations can be made, on a case-by-case basis. Accommodations are ultimately at the professor's discretion.

If you face exceptional circumstances on a test day, you must utilize SES in order to be eligible for a make-up exam. We also appreciate if you reach out to us on the day to give us a heads up that you won't be present, but this is not a hard requirement. The most important thing is for you to get your personal situation resolved.

More details on Student Emergency Services (SES): Student Emergency Services in the Office of the Dean of Students helps students and their families during difficult or emergency situations. Assistance includes outreach, advocacy, intervention, support, and referrals to relevant campus and community resources. If you need to be absent from class due to a family emergency, medical or mental health concern, or academic difficulty due to crisis or an emergency situation, you can work with Student Emergency Services. SES will document your situation and notify your professors. Additional information is available at: deanofstudents.utexas.edu/emergency/ or by calling 512-471-5017.

Academic Integrity Expectations:

Plagiarism and Misconduct: Students who violate University rules on academic misconduct are subject to the student conduct process. A student found responsible for academic misconduct may be assigned both a status sanction and a grade impact for the course. The grade impact could range from a zero on the assignment in question up to a failing grade in the course. A status sanction can include a written warning, probation, deferred suspension, or dismissal from the University. To learn more about academic integrity standards, tips for avoiding a potential academic misconduct violation, and the overall conduct process, please visit the [Student Conduct and Academic Integrity](#) website.

See discussion of course materials below for related academic integrity expectations around **intellectual property** and **student privacy**.

University-approved Function + Religious Holiday Conflicts:

In general, the student must inform the professor/TA, with proper documentation, well before the deadline or scheduled exam time, so that the professor/TA can work on alternative arrangements. For religious holidays, By UT Austin policy, the student must notify the professor/TA of the pending absence at least fourteen days prior to the date of observance of a religious holy day. If the student must miss a class, an examination, a work assignment, or a project in order to observe a religious holy day, the student will be given an opportunity to complete the missed work within a reasonable time after the absence.

The professor/TA expect you to respect them and your colleagues enough to never ask for preferential treatment in grading outside of these parameters. In particular:

- Never ask for extra credit on demand.
- Never ask for grade changes with no intellectual basis. In particular, do not request grade changes based on the professor's/TA's sympathy. But you SHOULD know that we are ready to give you ideas as to how to get closer to the grade you want. And, many experts in knowledge accumulation, pedagogy, and higher ed are employed by UT Austin to serve you – take advantage of this perk of being here.
- Never ask for retrospective accommodations for “extreme extenuating circumstances” that took place before you received a grade that is not at the level you hoped. The definition of an extreme extenuating circumstance has nothing to do with your grade. Recall from above that you must involve SES in order to receive special accommodations due to extreme extenuating circumstances.

Generative Artificial Intelligence

The creation of artificial intelligence tools for widespread use is an exciting innovation. These tools have both appropriate and inappropriate uses in classwork. The use of artificial intelligence tools (such as ChatGPT) on exams for this class is moot, as all exams are handwritten and in-person. The use of AI on quizzes and in other contexts is *discouraged*, because relying on AI reasoning will impede your ability to learn the material yourself. However, we are not enforcing a no-AI policy, and if responsible use of AI indeed helps you in your learning, that is consistent with our goals.

The professor reserves the right to enforce an anti-AI policy if and when circumstances arise in

the course. Students will be notified if and when this is the case. If violation of the policy is suspected under these circumstances, the student will automatically be referred to judicial services for adjudication, as is the policy at UT Austin as a whole. Class penalties for policy violations range from a zero on the assignment to a zero in the course.

Overview of all Major Course Requirements and Assignments

This course is designed to be easy to follow via **Modules**. Each week of the course has a dedicated page, in which you will see that week's required readings, recommended readings, lecture topics, slides (posted ahead of class), and a link to the end of week quiz (where applicable).

We ask you to rely on **Modules** to follow the course in specific detail. The content in this section is only a sketch of our plans. The Professor reserves the right to update course plans and materials depending on our progress. All such changes will be documented in **Modules** but not here.

===== *Module 0/3: Introduction* =====

Intro week 1/1: What is IPE, and how will we study it?

=== *Module 1/3: Politics of International Finance* ===

Finance week 1/5: The politics of money

Finance week 2/5: National money on the international stage

Finance week 3/5: Exchange rate politics

Finance week 4/5: Financial crisis

Finance week 5/5: Wrap-up and exam

=== *Module 2/3: Politics of International Trade* ===

Trade week 1/4: Trade as a tool for development

Trade week 2/4: Winners and losers from trade

Trade week 3/4: National- and international-level trade policy

Trade week 4/4: Wrap-up and exam

=== *Module 3/3: Politics of Multinational Corporations (MNCs)* ===

MNC week 1/4: International business as a "weapon"?

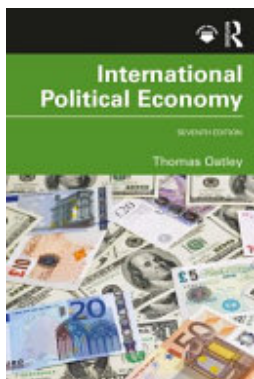
MNC week 2/4: Goals of MNCs v. Goals of governments

MNC week 3/4: Future of MNCs?

MNC week 4/4: Wrap-up and exam

Note: MNC exam administered during Finals week.

Required Course Materials



International Political Economy

ISBN: 9781000771695

Authors: Thomas H. Oatley

Publisher: Routledge

Publication Date: 2022-11-30

Edition: 7th edition

You can access the textbook through the "My Textbooks" tab in Canvas. You will be billed for it through the Longhorn Textbook Access (LTA) program unless you request otherwise. (See below, Recommended Course Materials, for more information)

All other materials will be accessible via our Canvas page

All non-textbook readings and other materials for the course will be accessible via our Canvas page.

Recommended Course Materials

Longhorn Textbook Access (LTA): The materials for this class are available through the Longhorn Textbook Access (LTA) program, a collaboration between UT Austin, The University Co-op and textbook publishers to significantly reduce the cost of digital course materials for students. You can access your required materials through the “My Textbooks” tab in Canvas. You are automatically opted into the program but can easily opt-out (and back in) via Canvas through the 12th class day. If you remain opted-in at the end of the add/drop period (12th class day fall/spring, 4th class day summer sessions), you will receive a bill through your “What I Owe” page. If you do not pay your bill by the specified deadline, you will lose access to the course materials and your charge will be removed. More information about the LTA program is available at [Longhorn Textbook Access](#) website.

Sharing of Course Materials is Prohibited: No materials used in this class, including, but not limited to, lecture hand-outs, videos, assessments (quizzes, exams, papers, projects, homework assignments), in-class materials, review sheets, and additional problem sets, may be shared online or with anyone outside of the class without explicit, written permission of the instructor. Unauthorized sharing of materials promotes cheating. The University is aware of the sites used for sharing materials, and any materials found online that are associated with you, or any suspected unauthorized sharing of materials, will be reported to Student Conduct and Academic Integrity in the Office of the Dean of Students. These reports can result in initiation of the student conduct process and include charge(s) for academic misconduct, potentially resulting in sanctions, including a grade impact.

Confidentiality of Class Recordings: Any class recordings are reserved only for students in this class for educational purposes and are protected under FERPA. The recordings should not be shared outside the class in any form. Violation of this restriction by a student could lead to Student Misconduct proceedings.

Getting Help with Technology: Students needing help with technology in this course should contact the [ITS Service Desk](#) or your local support unit.

Final Exam Date and Time

The exam covering the last module of the course will be administered in person during the scheduled final exam period for this course. There is no comprehensive final exam for the course. The specific date and time is available in **Modules**.

Class Canvas Site Weblink

Class Canvas site: <https://utexas.instructure.com/courses/1398400>

A Notice of Academic Accommodations from Disability and Access (D&A)

In case of a disability and access issue: Students must use Disability and Access Services (D&A), <https://disability.utexas.edu/>. For accommodations to be implemented, students must have a prior accommodation letter from Disability and Access that we have discussed and signed. No accommodations will be made retroactively. Note that accommodations are ultimately determined based on the context of a specific course, as defined by the professor.

Accommodations for in-person, written tests: If your D&A approved accommodations apply to these circumstances, you must reach out to the TA well in advance of the test -- 2 weeks minimum -- to organize accommodations. We ultimately rely on your cooperation to make sure plans match with your requirements. Please help us help you.

More details on Disability Accommodations: If you are a student with a disability, or think you may have a disability, and need accommodations please contact Disability and Access (D&A). You may refer to D&A's website for contact and more information: <https://disability.utexas.edu/>. Please deliver your Accommodation Letter to the professor as early as possible in the semester so we can discuss your approved accommodations and get everything sorted out sooner rather than later.

University Policies and Resources for Students Canvas Page

This Canvas [page](#) is a supplement to all UT syllabi and contains University policies and resources that you can refer to as you engage with and navigate your courses and the university.

Other Helpful Information

This is content on University Policies that we have found useful to highlight in the past. More information on these and other policies are available on the page linked in the previous section.

Student Health and Welfare:

Counseling and Mental Health Center (CMHC): We all benefit from support during times of struggle. Know you are not alone. If you are experiencing signs of stress, anxiety, depression, academic concerns, loneliness, difficulty sleeping, or any other concern impacting your well-being – you are strongly encouraged to connect with CMHC. The Counseling and Mental Health Center is located on campus and provides a wide variety of mental health services to all UT students,

including crisis services, counseling services with immediate support and well-being resources. Additionally, CARE Counselors are located within each of the academic schools and colleges. These counselors are familiar with the concerns that are unique to their unit's students. For more information on CMHC, visit <https://cmhc.utexas.edu/> or call 512-471-3515.

University Health Services: University Health Services is the on-campus medical facility providing high quality medical care and patient education to UT students. For additional information, visit <https://healthyhorns.utexas.edu/> or call 512-471-4955.

Title IX Reporting: Beginning January 1, 2022, Texas Education Code, Section 51.252 (formerly known as Senate Bill 212) requires all employees of Texas universities, including faculty, report any information to the Title IX Office regarding sexual harassment, sexual assault, dating violence, and stalking that is disclosed to them. Texas law requires that all employees who witness or receive any information of this type (including, but not limited to, written forms, applications, one-on-one conversations, class assignments, class discussions, or third-party reports) must report it to the Title IX Coordinator. Before talking with me, or with any faculty or staff member about a Title IX related incident, please remember that I will be required to report this information. If you would like to speak with a Case Manager for Support and Resources, who can provide support, resources, or academic accommodations, in the Title IX Office, please email: supportandresources@austin.utexas.edu. A Case Manager can also provide support, resources, and accommodations for pregnant, nursing, and parenting students. For more information about reporting options and resources, please visit: <https://titleix.utexas.edu>, contact the Title IX Office via email at: titleix@austin.utexas.edu, or call 512-471-0419.